

A DATA STORY FOR MARKETING TEAMS

What 70+ Growing Companies Reveal About Marketing-Led Growth

A plain-language look at revenue, growth and pricing patterns across a sample of startups, with a spotlight on what it means for marketing

Source: TrustMRR startup dataset

What Are We Looking At?

In plain terms, before we dive into charts:

1

The dataset

A public list of real online companies, each showing how much money they make and how fast that's changing.

2

“MRR”

Monthly Recurring Revenue — the reliable income a company collects every month, like a subscription fee.

3

“Growth %”

How much bigger (or smaller) that monthly income got over the last 30 days.

4

Why marketers care

Every number here was shaped by how well a company gets found, trusted, and paid — that's marketing at work.

The Big Picture

Across the leading companies in the dataset

74

companies
reviewed

\$54M+

combined yearly
revenue (categorized firms)

16

different business
categories

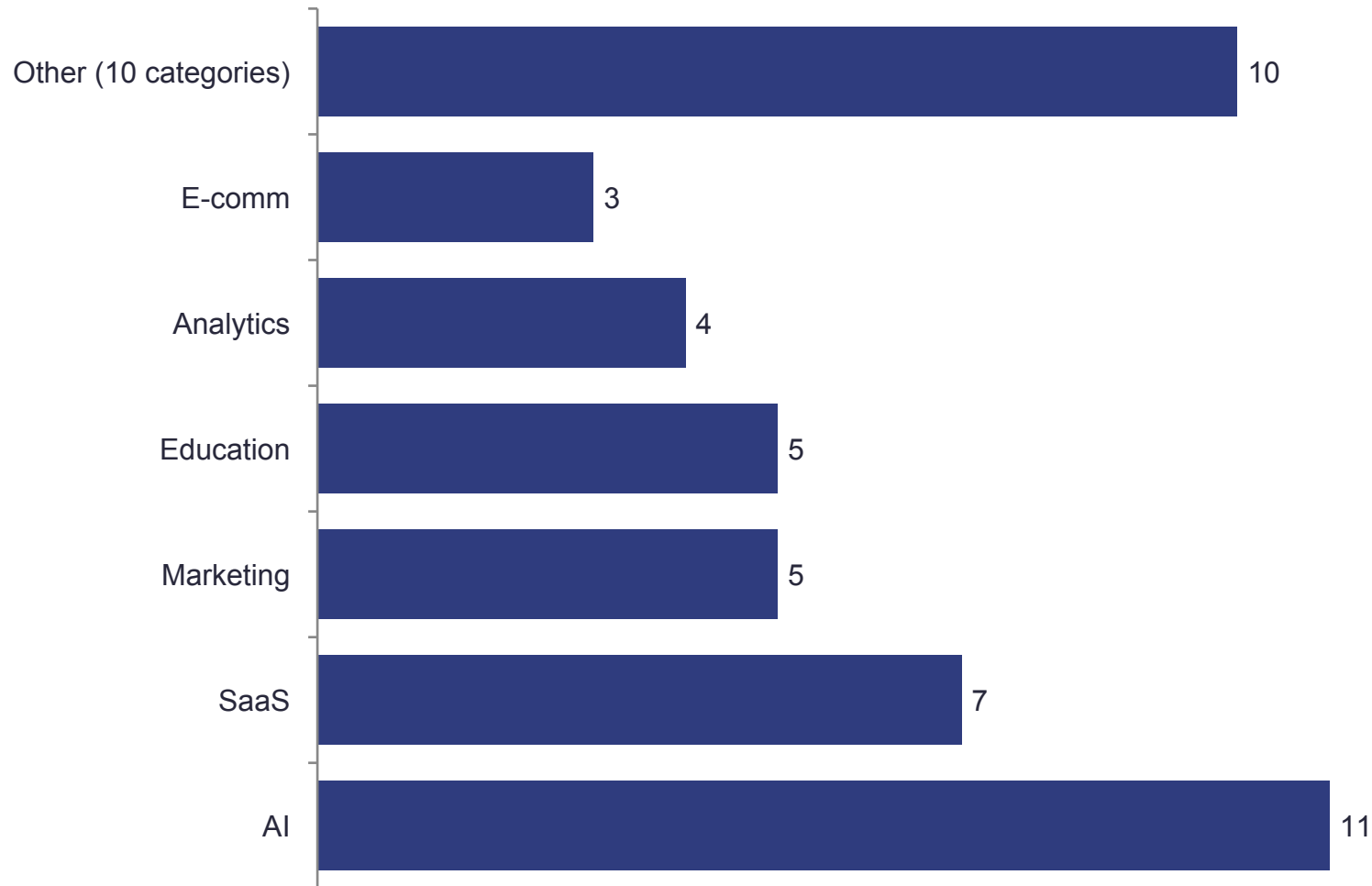
58%

sell to other
businesses (B2B)

Note: figures reflect the top revenue-ranked companies visible in the shared sheet, used as a representative sample.

Where the Companies Compete

Number of companies per business category



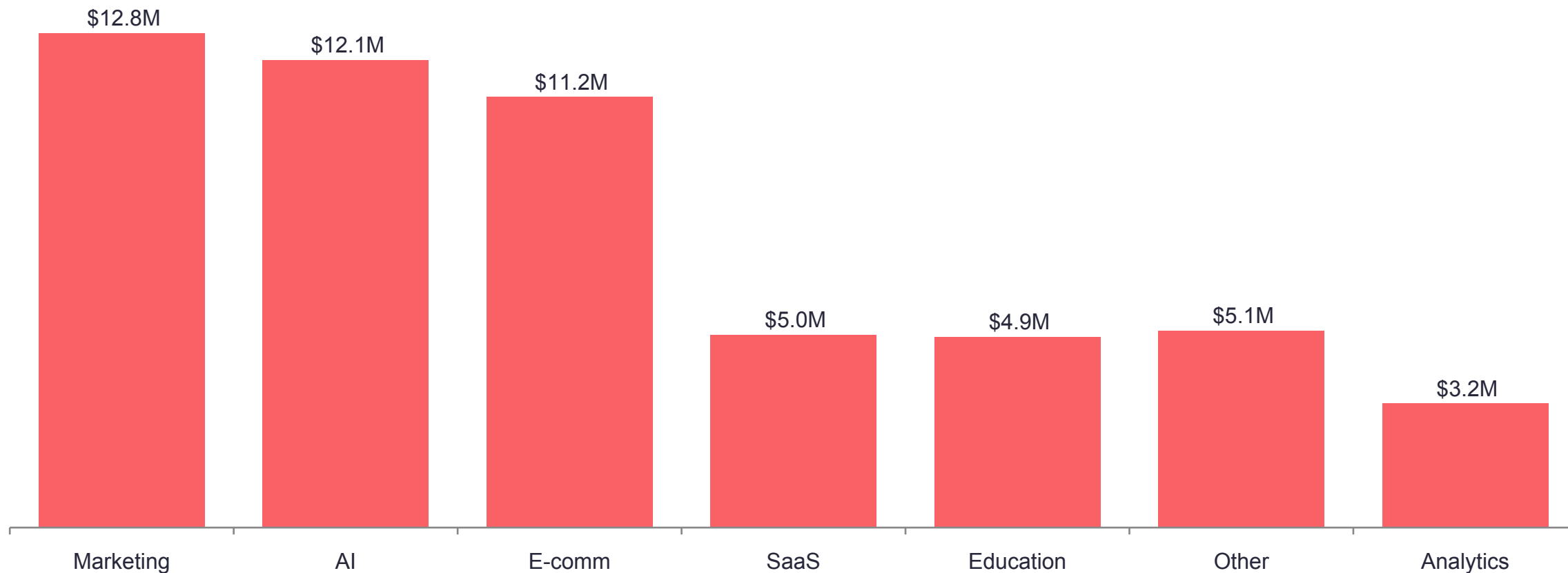
In simple terms

AI and SaaS tools are the most common businesses in this sample.

But “Marketing”-category companies punch above their weight on revenue, as we'll see next.

Which Categories Bring in the Most Money

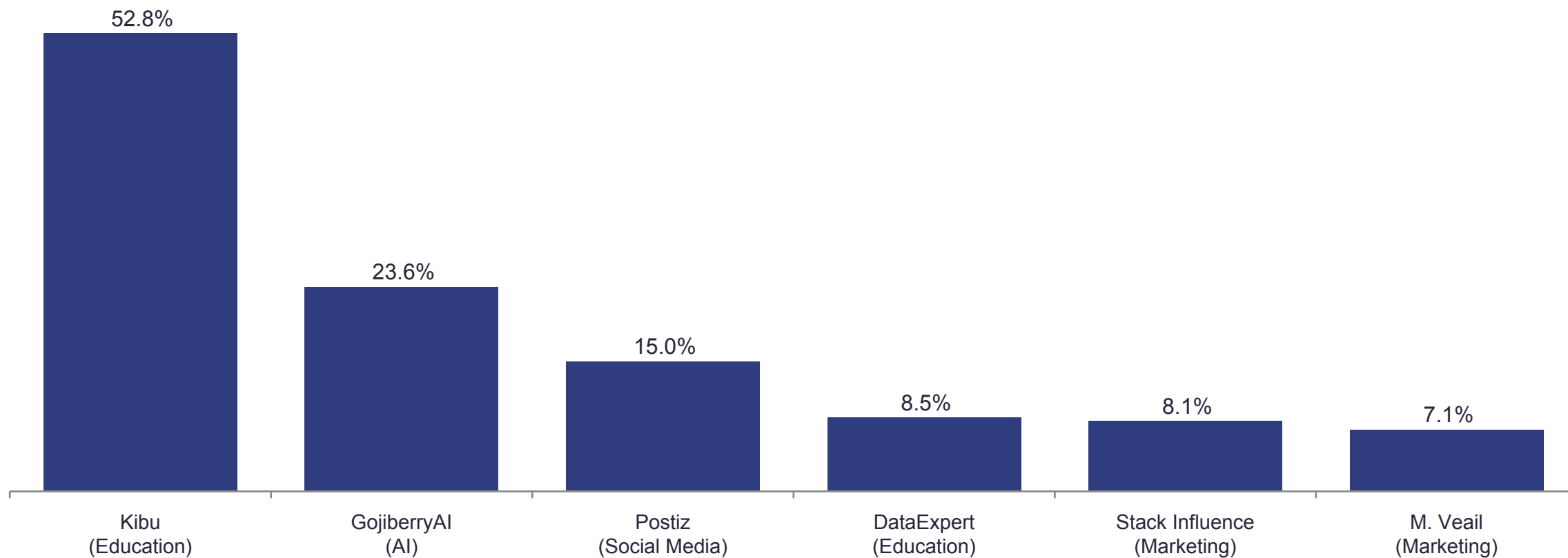
Combined 12-month revenue by category (USD millions)



Marketing-category companies generated the single largest slice of revenue in this sample — led by an influencer-marketing platform — even though they were only 5 of the 45 categorized companies.

Who's Growing the Fastest

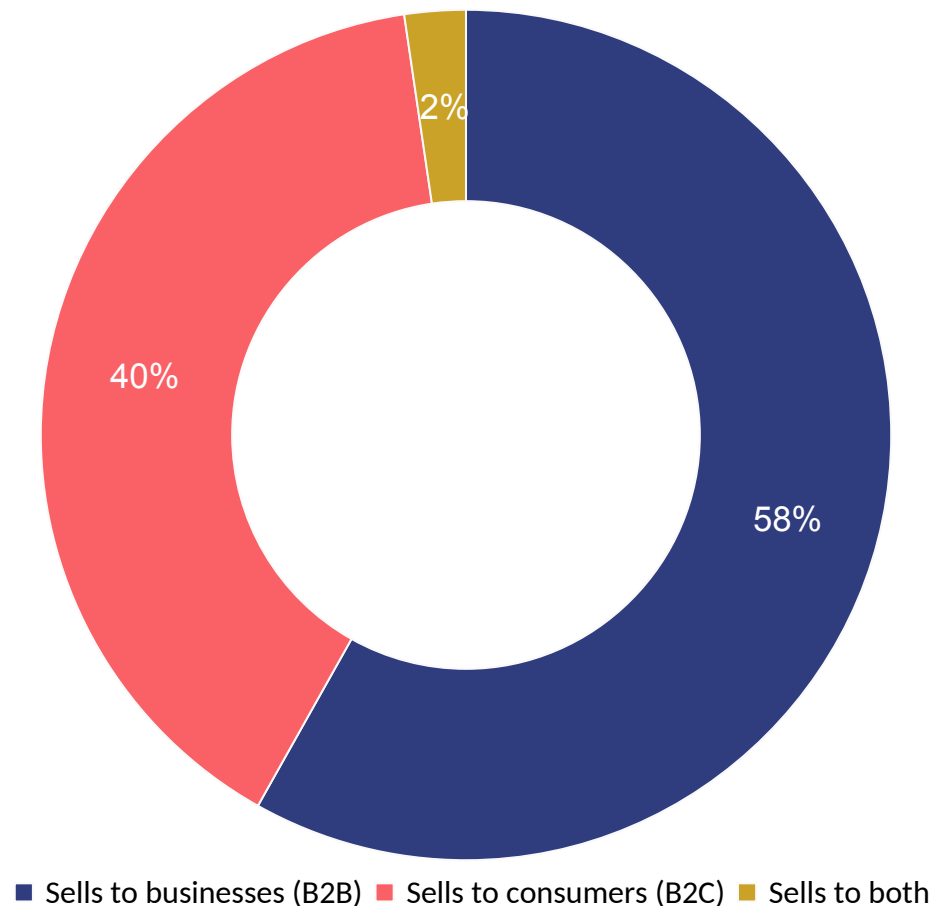
Monthly revenue growth, top performers (last 30 days)



Two of the six fastest-growing companies are Marketing-category businesses — a sign that marketing services themselves are a fast-growing thing to sell.

Who Do They Sell To?

Business customers vs. everyday consumers



What this means for marketers

- Most of these companies (about 3 in 5) sell to other businesses, not directly to individual shoppers.
- That means their marketing leans on trust, case studies and direct outreach — not just social ads.
- The consumer-facing minority still matters: they often grow through content and word of mouth instead.

Spotlight: The Marketing Companies

Five companies whose entire product IS marketing

Company	What they do (in one line)	12-mo revenue
Stack Influence	Automates creator/influencer collaborations for brands	\$10.5M
Launch Club	SEO and growth boost packages for startups	\$0.75M
LocalRank.so	Helps local SEO agencies rank clients #1 on Google	\$0.53M
Indexsy	Operator-led SEO, content and link building	\$0.82M
The Lead Guy	Exclusive lead generation for trades businesses	\$0.18M

Takeaway: the winners in this niche sell a repeatable service (SEO, leads, creator deals) with clear, plain-English pricing — not a vague “marketing platform.”

How These Companies Charge Customers

The pricing patterns that show up again and again

1

Monthly tiers

e.g. “Basic \$67 / Pro \$197 / Enterprise \$397” — by far the most common approach.

2

Free-to-start

Let people try it free, then charge once they get real value (“freemium”).

3

Pay-per-use / credits

Charge based on how much someone actually uses — common for AI tools.

4

Flat project fee

One clear price for one clear job — popular with agency-style services.

Some of These Companies Are for Sale

A quick look at the buy-and-sell market for this kind of business

23%

of companies in the
sample are listed for sale

3.2x

average asking price,
as a multiple of yearly revenue

In plain terms

A buyer would typically pay about 3 years' worth of a company's current yearly revenue to acquire it outright. Strong, steady growth pushes that multiple higher.

Key Takeaways

What this means if you work in marketing

1

Marketing-as-a-service is itself a proven, high-revenue category — not just a cost center for other businesses.

2

Simple, clearly-tiered pricing shows up in almost every successful company here — confusing pricing is a growth blocker.

3

B2B still dominates this space, so trust-building content (case studies, proof, direct outreach) outperforms broad awareness ads.

4

Fast growth is achievable without huge followings — several top performers had modest social followings but strong retention.

So What Should We Do With This?



Position marketing work as a revenue driver, using these real numbers as proof it pays off.



Borrow the pricing playbook: clear tiers, a free entry point, and one flagship price.



Prioritize trust-building content for B2B prospects over broad brand awareness alone.

Thank you — questions welcome.